

# NEED FOR SPEED Most Wanted

**The streets are a free-for-all now. The recipe for the day is tune, race, irritate the police, RUN!**

For two releases now, EA banished us from respectable society and sent us to the dark, dingy world of illegal street racing. While we did enjoy the night-time races in our mean machines, one thing still rankled. You see, the Dark Side isn't much fun without a good old-fashioned war with the goody-

goodies, and this left an unnamed emptiness inside. We yearned for the days of yore when cops from all over would stumble over themselves trying to capture us.

With *Need for Speed: Most Wanted*, EA brings some more sweetness and light into our lives. The racing is still dead fast—and just as illegal, but now we have our friendly Boys in Blue to remind us, should that slip our minds.

## The Script

The Career Mode reveals the plot (if you can really call it that) of NFSMW's story—you are a nameless street racer with a fine steed, looking for a race in the small town of Rockport. You bump into an degenerate named Razor, who is at the bottom of the Blacklist—a ranking of the best and most wanted racers in town. He gives you the race you seek, but sabotages your car, steals it, and hands you over to the cops on a silver platter. You get out of jail and

find Razor has been using your car to get to the top of the Blacklist. You need revenge. To reach Razor, you must work your way up the Blacklist by defeating each racer on it.

The story is told in stylised full-motion video cutscenes, and the acting is awful. So awful, in fact, it's actually hilarious—one wonders if EA did this on purpose. Helping you on your journey is Mia Townsend, played by Josie Maran, though you don't really know why she's helping you. Apart from the cutscenes she keeps sending you tips and news via text and voice messages. You are also helped by a mysterious guy named Rog, who also keeps sending you text and voice-mail messages telling you what's going on in the racing world.

Making your way up the Blacklist isn't as easy as it sounds. These are elite racers, and you need to make yourself worthy before you take them on. You must win races and build a reputation among racers and the police as a wild menace to society. Naturally, as you move along, this is to become tougher, but not gradually like one would expect—your opponents seem to get a sudden revelation somewhere around the middle, and now the slightest error can leave you coughing up dust.

The story itself is quite cheesy, but grips you enough to make you want to see it through to the end. Do you get your car back? Do you get the girl? What will Razor resort to? Find out in the next chilling episode!

## Enter The Cops...

... who are the real stars of the show this time. Every race carries with it the possibility of their suddenly turning up and adding some fun to the party. Looking for a chase? The Career Mode even lets you jump right into pursuits to get yourself better known in lawful circles. As usual, you can listen in on the police radio



Ah... beautiful, unsuspecting Rockport



Ha! Those cops won't find me in this stadium!



Sometimes you just need faith...



One with the road

